

Raw-pixel Validation of a 40.5717-day Eclipse Candidate Associated with TIC 31065777

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ABSTRACT

I report raw-pixel validation of five eclipse-like events associated with TIC 31065777 in public Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite observations. The target appears in the unvetted, unvalidated supplement to the TESS Ten Thousand Catalog but not in its validated eclipsing-binary sample. Events in Sectors 8, 9, 35, 36, and 89 follow a linear ephemeris with period 40.5717302 ± 0.0000688 days. A 1.5-pixel aperture gives a median fitted depth of 6.207%, and a joint trapezoid fit gives a duration of 2.920 ± 0.041 hr. Period estimates are stable across aperture sizes and leave-one-sector-out tests. Missing-light centroids fall 0.16–0.51 TESS pixel from the catalog position. The data support an ordinary eclipsing companion or unresolved blended system; photometry alone does not establish the companion class.

1. ANALYSIS

The Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite (TESS; [G. R. Ricker et al. 2015](#)) observed TIC 31065777 at R.A. = 135.070042° , decl. = -45.052218° in multiple sectors. I encountered the target during an exploratory search of public MIT Quick-Look Pipeline (QLP; [C. X. Huang et al. 2020](#)) light curves. A subsequent exact-TIC cross-match found the source in Table 2, the unvetted and unvalidated machine-learning candidate list of [V. B. Kostov et al. \(2025a\)](#), but not in their Tables 3 or 4 of validated new or previously known eclipsing binaries. The analysis here tests that candidate at the pixel level and incorporates the later Sector 89 observation.

I downloaded 15 by 15 pixel TESSCut products from the Mikulski Archive for Space Telescopes for Sectors 8, 9, 35, 36, and 89. I retained finite, quality-zero cadences and subtracted each cadence’s median border-pixel background. Circular apertures of radii 1.0, 1.5, 2.0, and 2.5 pixels were centered on the TESS Input Catalog position ([K. G. Stassun et al. 2019](#)). Within 0.55 days of each expected event, I divided the aperture sum by its local out-of-event median. A joint least-squares trapezoid model used a shared epoch, period, duration, and ingress fraction, with a separate depth, baseline, and linear trend for each sector. I then refit event centers at a fixed joint shape and fit their cycle numbers $N = (0, 1, 18, 19, 54)$ with

$$T_N = 1527.534962(337) + N 40.571730224(688) \text{ BTJD}, \quad (1)$$

where BTJD is BJD -2457000 and parentheses give the uncertainty in the final digits.

2. VALIDATION AND INTERPRETATION

The five 1.5-pixel-aperture depths span 5.973%–6.663%, with median 6.207% (Figure 1). The joint duration is 2.9198 ± 0.0408 hr. Across the four aperture radii, fitted periods span only 1.61 s. Leaving out each sector in turn predicts the omitted event to within 1.90 minutes; a 2000-trial parametric bootstrap of event-center errors gives a 95% period interval of 40.57160–40.57187 days. These uncertainties propagate measured event-center errors and do not constitute a blind-search false-alarm probability because the target and events were selected after inspecting the data.

Four blank apertures offset by four pixels show maximum absolute apparent depths of 0.10%–0.94%, and target-aperture windows shifted by one or two days reach 0.34%, all below the 6.2% event signal. Difference-image missing-light centroids are 0.16–0.51 TESS pixel from the target position, and every sector passes the same quality, coherence,

timing, and greater-than- 5σ localization-depth criteria. This reduces resolved-background and time-localized instrumental explanations, but a TESS pixel is approximately $21''$ (G. R. Ricker et al. 2015); unresolved blending remains possible.

The measurements therefore support a recurring eclipse candidate associated with the TIC 31065777 aperture. They do not demonstrate a planet, determine a companion mass, or fully identify the eclipsed source. Multicolor time-series photometry at higher angular resolution can test chromaticity and blending, while spectroscopy can determine whether the system is a stellar binary. Code, derived tables, source-product hashes, and an executable evidence packet are archived at Zenodo (H. Barrientos 2026).

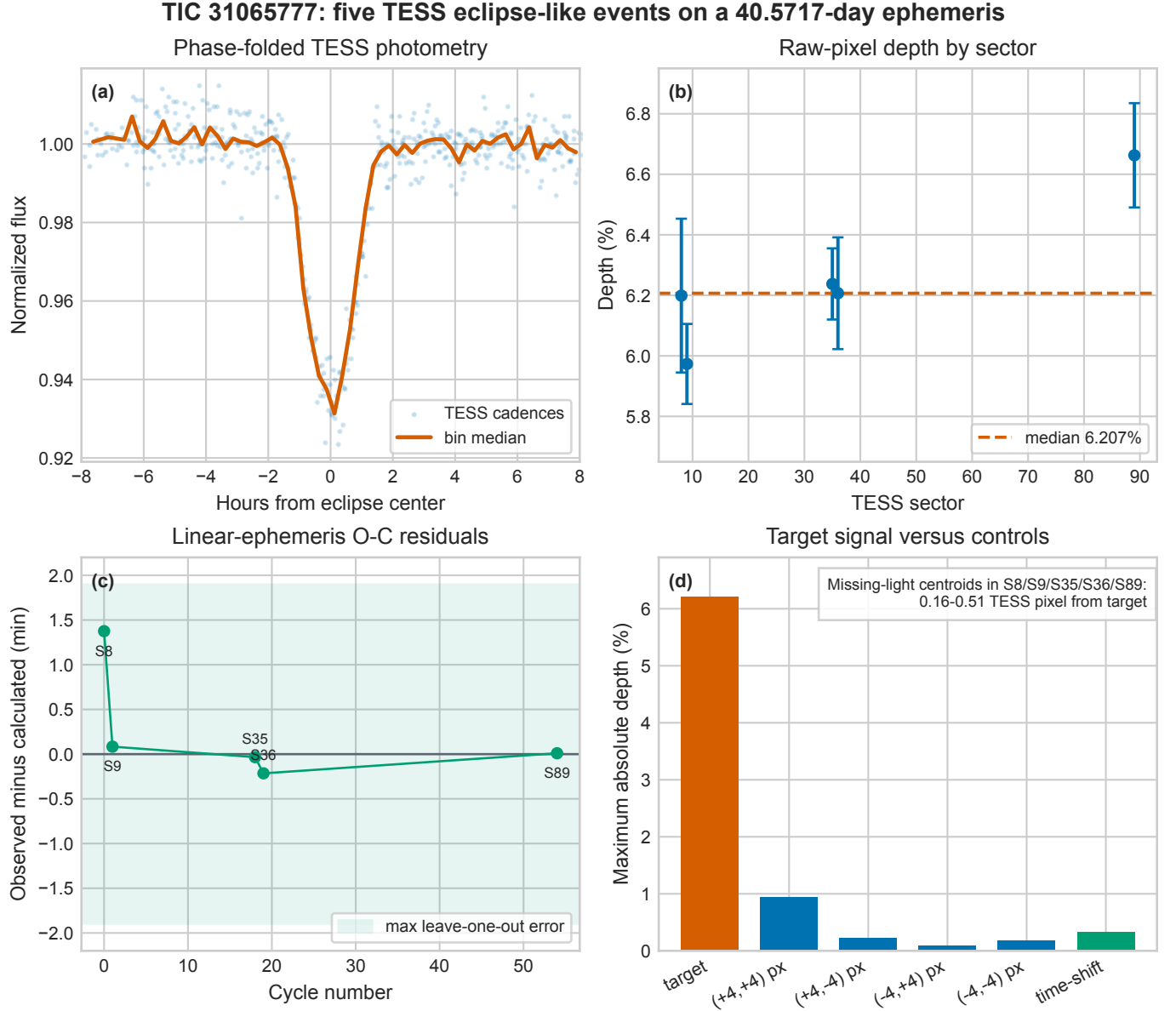


Figure 1. Five-event photometric validation of TIC 31065777. (a) Individual phase-folded TESS cadences (light blue) and bin medians (orange). (b) Fitted 1.5-pixel-aperture depths with 1σ errors; the dashed line is their median. (c) Observed-minus-calculated event-center residuals; the shaded band marks the largest leave-one-sector-out prediction error. (d) Target median depth compared with the maximum absolute signal at four blank apertures and at time-shifted target windows. The annotation gives missing-light centroid separations.

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Facility: TESS

Software: Astropy (Astropy Collaboration et al. 2022), Lightkurve (Lightkurve Collaboration et al. 2018), NumPy, pandas, SciPy, Matplotlib

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